

SOS Incident Response Guide

Step-by-step: what to do if something happens to your child online

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FIRST: STAY CALM

Your child came to you. That is the most important thing. Your reaction right now determines whether they come to you again in the future. Do not shout. Listen first.

✓ Say this first: "Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing. You are not in trouble. Let's figure this out together."

SCENARIO 1 — INAPPROPRIATE MESSAGES RECEIVED

- 1 Do not delete anything yet — screenshots are evidence
- 2 Take screenshots of all messages including the sender's profile
- 3 Block the sender on the platform
- 4 Report to the platform using the built-in report button
- 5 Report to NCMEC CyberTipline: cybertipline.org
- 6 Check your child is emotionally okay — offer counseling if needed

SCENARIO 2 — SEXTORTION

⚠ Do not pay. Do not send more images. Payment always leads to more demands.

- 1 Stay calm — reassure your child they are not in trouble
- 2 Screenshot all communications before blocking
- 3 Block on all platforms
- 4 Report to FBI: ic3.gov
- 5 Report to NCMEC: cybertipline.org
- 6 Contact the platform for image removal — see the federal law below that now requires this
- 7 Seek professional counseling for your child

SCENARIO 3 — CHILD WANTS TO MEET SOMEONE ONLINE

- 1 Stay calm — keep the conversation open
- 2 Ask to see all conversations with this person
- 3 Contact local law enforcement if you suspect an adult posing as a child
- 4 Do NOT arrange to meet the person yourself

SCENARIO 4 — CYBERBULLYING

- 1 Document everything — screenshots with dates
- 2 Report to the platform
- 3 If from a schoolmate — report to school administration
- 4 If threats of violence — contact local police immediately

NEW FEDERAL LAW: THE TAKE IT DOWN ACT

Since May 2026, a federal law — the TAKE IT DOWN Act — gives you a much stronger tool than asking nicely. It requires platforms to remove non-consensual intimate images (including AI-generated "deepfakes") within **48 hours** of a verified request, with FTC penalties for platforms that don't comply.

NEW What to do: file a removal request directly with the platform citing the TAKE IT DOWN Act (most platforms now have a dedicated form). If they miss the 48-hour window, file a complaint with the FTC at ftc.gov/complaint — this is a real enforcement path, not just a suggestion.

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

 NCMEC (USA) 1-800-843-5678 cybertipline.org	 FBI Cyber Crime ic3.gov	 Crisis Text Line Text HOME to 741741	 FTC (Take It Down) ftc.gov/complaint	 Turkey BTK 158 ihbar.org.tr
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POST-INCIDENT CHECKLIST

- ☐ All evidence documented and saved
- ☐ Reported to platform and authorities
- ☐ All contact from perpetrator blocked
- ☐ Child reassured and emotionally supported
- ☐ Professional counseling considered
- ☐ Device and account security reviewed
- ☐ Follow-up conversation scheduled in 1 week